Hello Kiyo — Pre-launch business plan

A kawaii “build-your-box” shopping spree powered by vibes

Target: female 12–24. Offer: themed Japanese assortment boxes with no individual item pricing on the storefront. Shopify (headless later) + custom frontend demo.

Version: Investor demo
Date: 2026-04-25
Site: hellokiyo.com (demo)

1) Executive summary

Hello Kiyo sells a playful Japanese discovery experience: customers choose a box size, browse cute categories, and build a “spree” without seeing item prices. Checkout is box price + shipping + optional gift wrap.

- **Core product**: curated assortment box with customizable tiers.
- **Monetization**: box ticket (product-only) + shipping + gift wrap add-on.
- **Launch wedge**: $50 “Kiyo’s Mini” curated box (bulk buy + repeatable fulfillment).

Key operating principles

- **No item pricing**: the storefront sells the experience and category vibes, not SKU unit prices.
- **Shipping separate**: destination + box size determines Standard/Expedited quote.
- **Inventory-free** (except $50 curated): customizable tiers assume near-retail procurement.
- **Teen-girl alignment**: prioritize colorful, kawaii, low-yen items first within each category.

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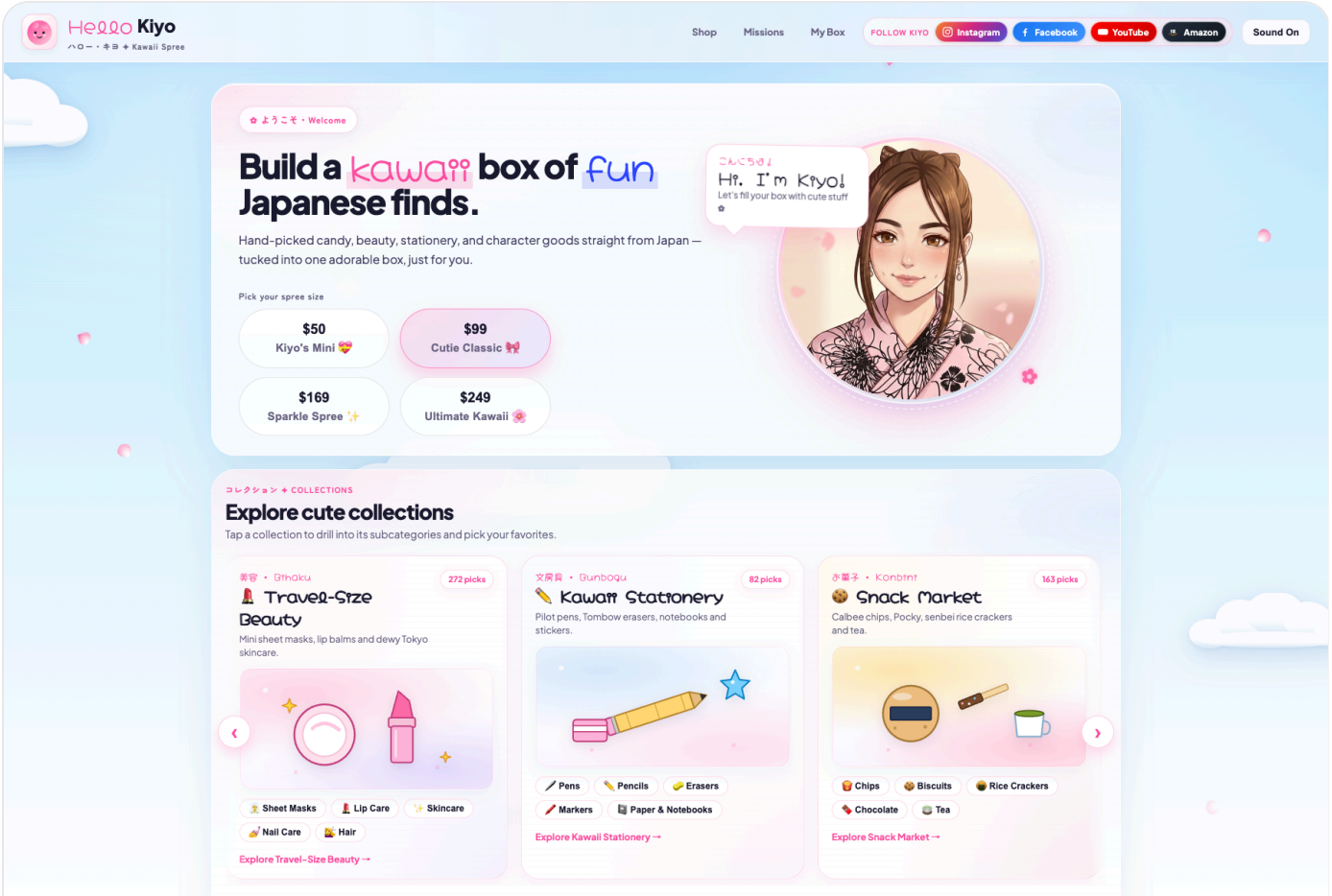
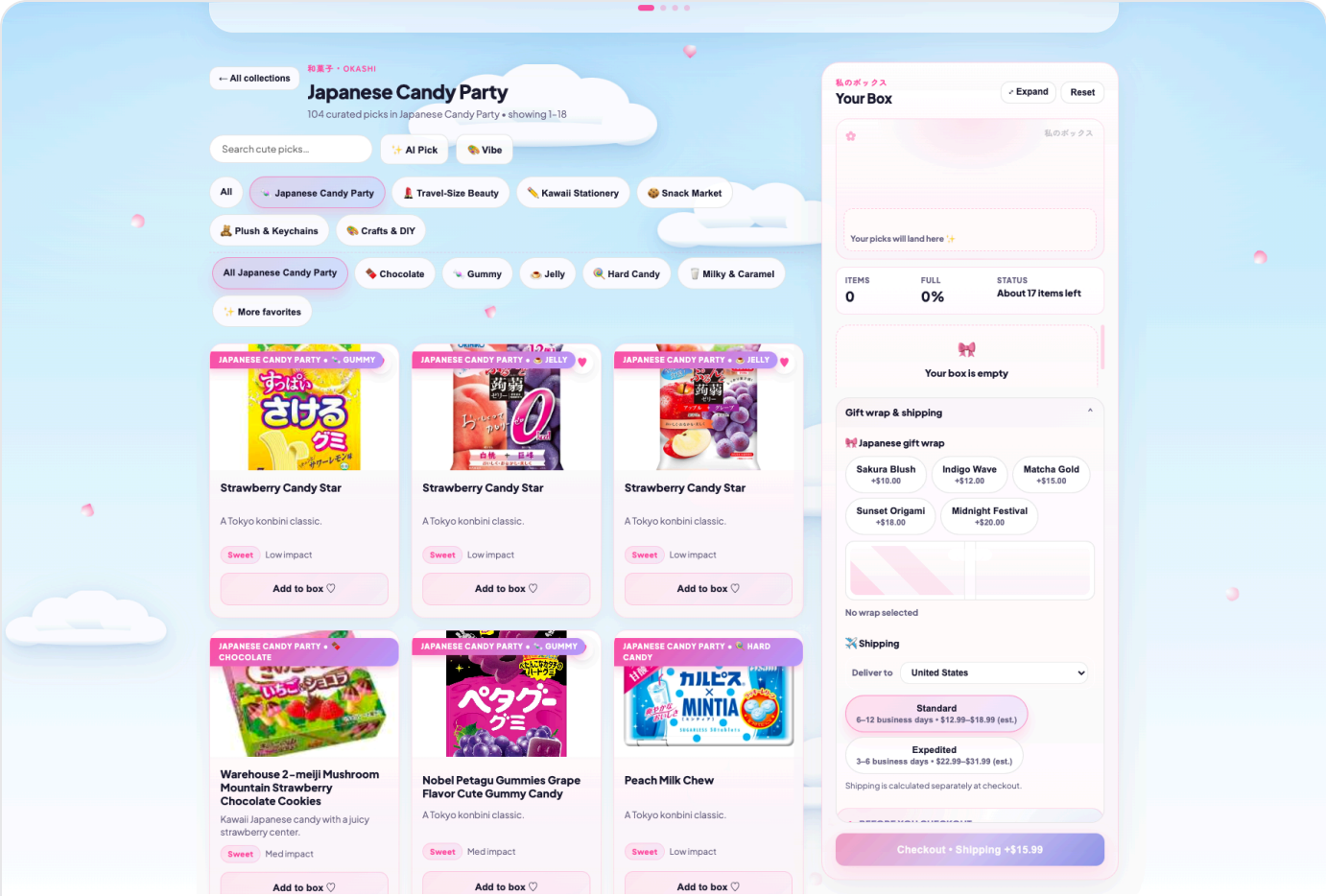
Note: page numbers are approximate and will shift as we iterate. The goal is a crisp narrative flow (no orphan headings).

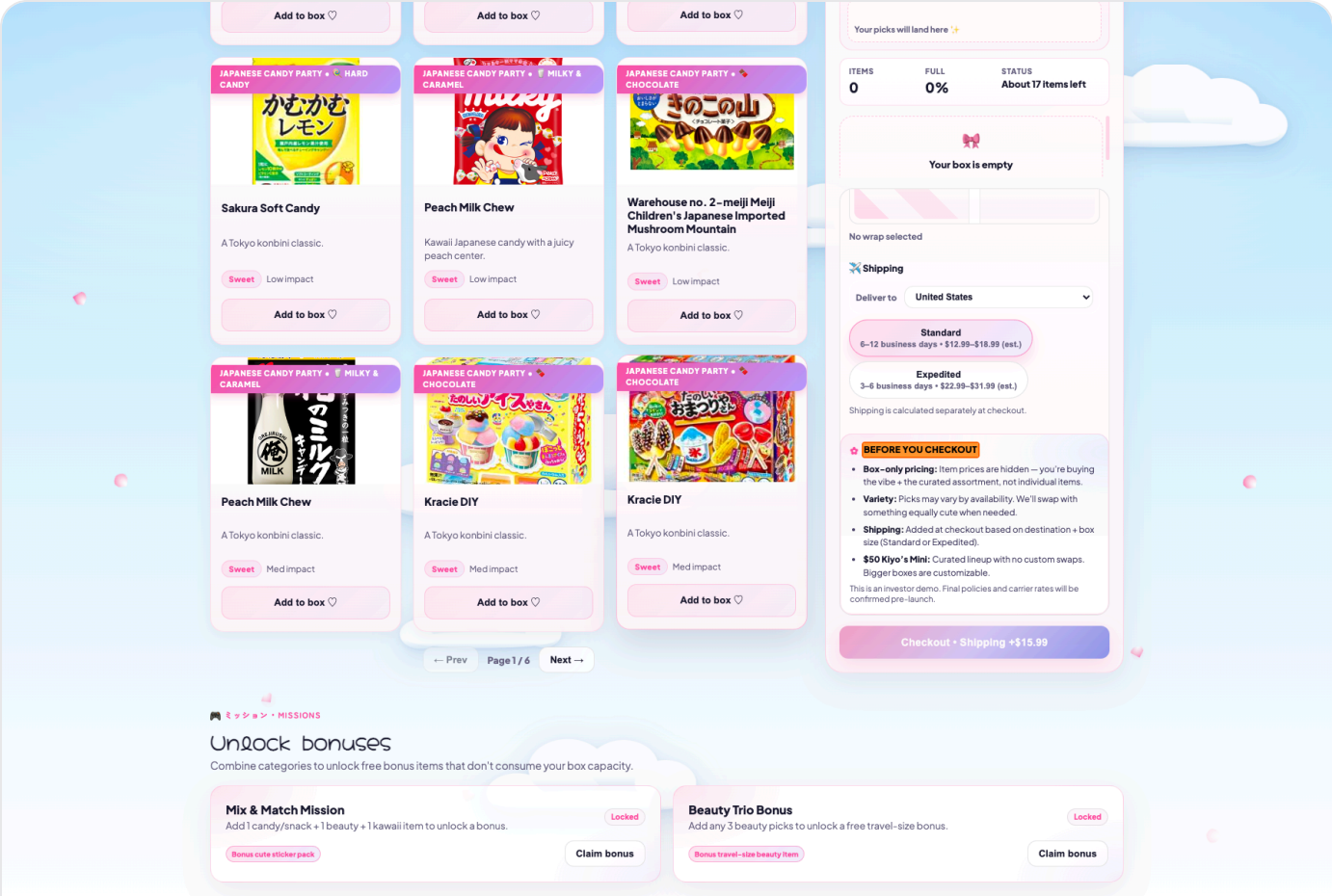
2) Product & UX



Hero + collections: spree sizes, mascot, and “Explore cute collections” carousel.



Catalog + shipping: defaults to Japanese Candy Party; shipping is quoted separately.



Disclosure: explains box-only pricing, substitutions, and shipping add-on.

3) Market, customer, and positioning

Who we win

- **Primary**: girls/young women 12–24 who love kawaii culture (Sanrio, anime, stickers, snack TikTok).
- **Secondary**: gift buyers (birthdays, back-to-school, holidays) and “Japan-curious” shoppers.
- **Psychographics**: novelty seeking, aesthetic-first shopping, creator-driven discovery.

Positioning

- **Not a SKU store**: this is an experience-led box with category vibes.
- **Game-like UX**: missions/bonuses + fun visual feedback, not discounting.
- **Brand mascot**: “Kiyo” anchors identity and content voice.

Competitive set: Japanese snack boxes, stationery subscriptions, influencer storefronts. Differentiator is **choose-your-vibe customization** + a merch/sponsorship flywheel.

4) Business model & unit economics

Revenue streams

- **Box tickets**: $50 / $99 / $169 / $249 (product-only)
- **Shipping add-on**: Standard or Expedited (destination + tier)
- **Gift wrap**: $10–$20 add-on
- **Sponsorship**: brand-funded inserts, “featured drops,” co-branded missions

Core unit economics assumptions

Net margin 38%

Payment 3%

Packaging $2

FX 158 ¥/$

Wholesale curated only (0.65×)

Custom inventory-free (1.00×)

These match the updated economics canvas. Shipping is charged separately and does not impact ticket margin.

ESTIMATED ITEMS PER TIER (¥500 MEDIAN ITEM)

Custom tiers show fewer items because procurement assumes near-retail to stay inventory-free.

NET MARGIN BY TIER (TICKET ONLY)

Target is stable net margin across tiers; shipping is separate.

Box tiers (customer-facing)

TIER	TICKET	POSITIONING	CUSTOMIZATION
Kiyo’s Mini	$50	Repeatable starter box (candy + snacks), curated by Kiyo	Locked (no adds / no swaps)
Cutie Classic	$99	Main conversion tier for “build your box” discovery	Customizable
Sparkle Spree	$169	More variety + more items, best for gifting	Customizable
Ultimate Kawaii	$249	Top tier for power shoppers + maximal surprise	Customizable

Shipping model (separate from ticket)

Customer experience

- **Two options**: Standard (6–12 biz days) and Expedited (3–6 biz days).
- **Estimated ranges**: shown in-UI per tier + destination; charged midpoint in demo.
- **Destination selector**: US, Canada, UK/EU, AU/NZ, Asia, Other.

Operational assumption (pre-launch)

Replace range tables with real carrier quoting (DHL/JP Post/UPS) as we lock packaging and weights. The current estimator is intentionally simple to validate the checkout mental model.

5) Sponsorship & brand partnerships

Why sponsors care

- Direct access to a high-intent Gen-Z kawaii audience
- Sampling into an **unboxing moment** (high share rate)
- Performance tracking via QR + codes + “mission unlock” attribution

Sponsorship packages (starting point)

- **Insert**: flyer + QR + mission sticker pack (CPM-like)
- **Sample**: 1–2 sponsored items in curated tier or “bonus unlock”
- **Featured drop**: hero placement + collection card + creator content
- **Co-branded box**: limited edition theme (e.g., “Sakura Glow”)

PACKAGE	WHAT YOU GET	MEASUREMENT	NOTES
Insert	Printed insert + QR + landing page	Scans, signups, “mission starts”	Low-friction starter package
Sample	Physical item sampling in box	Redemption, reorder intent survey	Best for candy/beauty minis
Featured drop	Hero + collection + creator activation	CTR, conversion lift, CAC offset	Requires content coordination
Co-branded	Limited edition box theme	Sell-through, PR value, waitlist	Quarterly tentpole

6) Go-to-market (GTM) plan

Launch narrative

- **Promise**: “Build a kawaii box of fun Japanese finds.”
- **Hook**: unboxing + missions + bonus unlocks
- **Wedge**: $50 curated tier for repeatability + fast feedback

Funnel (targets)

- **Top**: creator reach + paid social → landing
- **Mid**: pick tier → browse collections → add 6–12 items
- **Bottom**: checkout with shipping add-on
- **Retention**: post-purchase “mission” + referral code

90-DAY LAUNCH PLAN (HIGH LEVEL)

PHASE	WEEKS	PRIMARY GOAL	OUTPUTS
Pre-launch	1–4	Waitlist + creator seeding	20–40 creator kits, 50–100 UGC clips, email capture
Launch	5–8	Convert $50 + $99	Weekly drops, missions, affiliate codes, retargeting
Optimize	9–12	Improve CAC/LTV	Landing tests, bundle themes, sponsor pilots

7) Social media plan

Content pillars

- **Unboxing ASMR** (satisfying packaging)
- **Snack tests** (reaction + ranking)
- **Kawaii crafts** (stationery + DIY)
- **Kiyo POV** (mascot voice)

Cadence (starter)

- **TikTok**: 2–3 posts/week
- **IG Reels**: 2–3 posts/week
- **YouTube Shorts**: 2–3 posts/week
- **Facebook Reels**: 2–3 posts/week

Creator engine

- Micro-influencers (10k–150k)
- Affiliate codes + free box
- Sponsor-funded "drops"
- UGC licensing for ads

Measurement: track view-through conversions, landing CTR, add-to-box, checkout completion, and post-purchase referral. Sponsors get QR attribution + "mission starts."

KIYO CREATOR INCOME (SEPARATE FROM SITE)

Monetization streams

- **UGC (brand content)**: brands pay for short-form ads Kiyo produces (does not require a huge following).
- **Affiliate**: Amazon storefront + link-in-bio for featured items.
- **Sponsorships**: paid integrations once average views are consistent.
- **Usage rights**: add-on fee for brands to run Kiyo's content as ads ("whitelisting").

With 2–3 posts/week, the most reliable early money is UGC + affiliate; sponsorship scales later.

Income scenarios (creator-only)

SCENARIO	MONTHLY	DRIVER
Conservative	$600–$1,100	1 UGC + light affiliate
Base	$2,400–$4,900	2–3 UGC + some affiliate + 1 sponsor/mo
Aggressive	$7,800–$17,200	4–6 UGC + strong affiliate + 1–2 sponsors/mo

These ranges depend on average views (not follower count). UGC rates rise with proof + repeatable performance.

Operational advantage: the box business produces constant "unboxing" content. The creator business can become a separate P&L (media + licensing) that also reduces ecommerce CAC.

8) Operations plan & maturity timeline

Phase 1 (0–3 months): curated-first

- Stock only the $50 curated manifest
- Lock packaging + weight bands
- Validate shipping estimator with real carrier rates

Phase 2 (3–9 months): customize + substitute

- Codify substitution rules by vibe/subcategory
- Introduce limited “drops” for scarcity
- Begin wholesale relationships for repeat SKUs

9) Risks, mitigations, and compliance

CAC volatility (paid social)

Severity High

Likelihood Med

Mitigation: creator-first acquisition, UGC licensing, retargeting guardrails, and sponsor-funded drops.

Food import / compliance

Severity High

Likelihood Low–Med

Mitigation: source via compliant exporters, maintain ingredient lists, avoid restricted items, documented SOPs.

“No item pricing” trust gap

Severity Med

Likelihood Med

Mitigation: prominent disclosure, preview examples, substitution promise, and a generous support posture.

Shipping variance / chargebacks

Severity Med

Likelihood Med

Mitigation: quote by destination+tier, lock packaging weights, integrate carrier rates, buffer ranges.

RISK	IMPACT	MITIGATION
“No item pricing” confusion	Trust / refunds	Clear disclosures, preview examples, consistent “vibe” promise, easy support.
International shipping variance	Margin leakage	Quote by destination + tier; lock packaging; integrate carrier rates; buffer ranges.
Food import/compliance	Delays / seizures	Source from compliant exporters; maintain ingredient lists; avoid restricted items; documented SOP.
Inventory-free custom tiers	Stockouts	Substitution logic, supplier redundancy, “drops” limits, and gradual wholesale for repeat items.

10) Roadmap & future opportunities

Opportunities

- Co-branded boxes with anime/game IP
- Seasonal tentpoles (Sakura, Summer Matsuri, Halloween)
- Membership perks (early drops, rare bonus unlocks)
- Retail pop-ups + collab events

Product roadmap

- Carrier quoting integration
- Real “missions” reward inventory + sponsor funding
- Headless Shopify checkout + subscriptions
- Referral program + influencer portal

Appendix: Economics highlights (from canvas)

38%
Net margin target (ticket only)

3%
Payment processing reserve

$2
Packaging absorbed per box

158
Unified FX rate (¥/$)

Key point: “No item pricing” is feasible when the customer purchases an **assortment experience** (curated box) rather than a cart of individually priced SKUs. You must disclose variability/substitutions, avoid guaranteed “retail value” claims unless provable, and maintain tight internal cost controls per tier.

Internal cost model in the demo:

```
product_budget = ticket × (1 − netMargin − paymentPct) − packaging
curated_unit_cost ≈ (retail_yen × 0.65) / 158 + $0.25 inbound handling
custom_unit_cost ≈ (retail_yen × 1.00) / 158 (inventory-free procurement)
```

Appendix: MBA-level growth model (targets & sensitivities)

Launch scope update: US-only for launch. Add subscription as the primary growth lever once fulfillment and compliance are stable. Family-operated (no wages); profits accrue to the family except for investor payback per the plan below.

Appendix: Startup costs, operating costs, and investor payback

Use of funds (initial $10,000)

LINE ITEM	BUDGET	NOTES
Business formation + compliance	$1,200	LLC, EIN, permits, basic legal templates
Brand + packaging setup	$1,800	Stickers, inserts, tissue, wrap materials, test runs
Initial curated inventory (Kiyo's Mini)	$3,500	Repeatable SKU mix to fulfill early orders
Shipping materials + scale	$600	Boxes, mailers, label printer, scale, tape
Hosting + tooling (12 months)	$900	Domain, email, storage, monitoring, optional Shopify fees
Creator seeding + UGC	$1,500	10–20 seeding kits + content licensing
Paid test budget	$500	Small paid social tests (creative validation)

Budget ranges can shift; the key is validating CAC + retention quickly.

Operating cost model (monthly, US-only)

CATEGORY	MONTHLY	NOTES
Software + hosting	$75–$200	Domain/email, analytics, hosting, shipping tools
Packaging replenishment	$0.60–$1.20 / order	Tissue, sticker, insert; separate from product budget
Customer support	$0 (family)	Time cost still exists; plan for 0.5–1.0 hr/day at 10 orders/day
Pick/pack labor	$0 (family)	Plan capacity: 10–20 orders/day with 2 people for 2–3 hours
Marketing	$500–$3,000	Creator seeding + paid tests; scale only when CAC works
Loss/return reserve	1–3% of revenue	Damage, replacements, goodwill

Subscription plan (US-only, after stability)

- **Offer**: monthly “Kawaii Spree” subscription (default $99), with seasonal themed drops.
- **Retention levers**: missions + bonus unlocks, “rare” monthly insert, referral reward.
- **Inventory approach**: curated tier has stocked SKUs; customizable tiers use substitute rules + small batch sourcing.

METRIC	CONSERVATIVE	TARGET	GREAT
Monthly churn	10%	6–8%	4–5%
Avg lifetime (months)	10	13–16	18–24
Payback window	2–3 months	1–2 months	<1 month

Investor request: $10K + payback plan

Structure designed for a family-operated business: no wages; cashflow primarily used for inventory rotation, packaging, and growth. Investor is repaid before owner distributions.

OPTION	MECHANIC	PAYBACK TARGET	NOTES
Revenue share note	5% of gross ticket revenue until 1.5× repaid	$15K total	Simple, aligns with top-line growth
Profit share note	20% of monthly net profit until 2× repaid	$20K total	Protects business in slow months
Hybrid	3% revenue share until $10K repaid, then 10% profit share to 1.75×	$17.5K total	Balances speed + downside protection

Exact terms to be finalized; this plan demonstrates repayment feasibility under realistic order volumes.

INVESTOR PAYBACK SCENARIOS (ILLUSTRATIVE)

SCENARIO	ORDERS/MONTH	AVG TICKET	REVENUE SHARE	MONTHS TO REPAY $15K

Assumes a 5% revenue share on ticket revenue only (shipping pass-through excluded).

$250K/year feasibility (orders)

$250K/year ≈ $20.8K/month. Orders/month depends on ticket mix (shipping is pass-through).

AVG TICKET	ORDERS/MONTH	ORDERS/DAY

CAC guardrails (back-of-napkin)

Contribution margin ≈ ticket × 38%. To stay healthy after overhead, the blended CAC should generally be below ~40–55% of contribution on the dominant tier.

TIER	TICKET	CONTRIBUTION (38%)	TARGET CAC RANGE

Sponsor revenue can effectively subsidize CAC by funding inserts/drops.

SENSITIVITY: CAC VS CONVERSION RATE (ILLUSTRATIVE)

Use this to sanity-check paid social: small changes in landing→checkout conversion swing allowable CAC. (Replace with real funnel telemetry post-launch.)

LANDING → CHECKOUT	ALLOWABLE CAC (IF $99 TIER DOMINATES)	NOTES

6) Ops plan (inventory-light launch)

Phase 1 (launch): curated-first

- Stock only the $50 curated manifest (repeatable picks)
- Pre-pack box components: tissue, wrap, inserts, stickers
- Standardize weight bands and lock carrier rates

Phase 2 (scale): customizable tiers

- Maintain “inventory-free” posture via small-batch sourcing and fast replenishment
- Introduce substitution rules by vibe + subcategory
- Gradually add wholesale relationships for top recurring SKUs

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